
Michael Hodgdon

Greater Phoenix Area · hodgdonmichael85@gmail.com · [LinkedIn](#)

Summary

Staff Software Engineer with experience in Cloud Security, Platform Engineering, and Developer Experience (DevEx). Currently lead engineer for PayPal's GitHub Enterprise Cloud, owning governance, tooling, and developer self-service across all 6+ organizations, 30,000 repositories, and 15,000 developers on the platform. Builds CI/CD frameworks and the custom GitHub Apps behind enterprise developer workflows, enforces enterprise-wide security-as-code, and scales infrastructure handling 200M+ daily calls. Co-inventor of a U.S. patent in behavior analytics and data exfiltration prevention.

Technical Skills

- **Cloud:** GCP (Professional Cloud Architect), Kubernetes (GKE), and Docker.
- **GitHub:** GitHub Enterprise Cloud (enterprise administrator), GitHub Actions, GitHub Apps, and Webhooks.
- **DevSecOps:** Terraform, Helm, ArgoCD, Jenkins, Harness, Ansible, Puppet, and JFrog Artifactory.
- **Security:** CISSP, CCSP, Traceable (API Security), Aqua (Vulnerability Management), and Signal Sciences (WAF).
- **Languages:** Python and Bash.

Professional Experience

PayPal, Scottsdale, AZ

Staff Software Engineer · 2020 – Present

Platform governance and developer experience

- Defined the branch-protection eligibility framework, exception and approval workflow, and self-service tool adopted across the company.
- Set and enforced GitHub-wide policy: org creation, service-account approval, mandatory dual-approval merges, and production branch protection.
- Integrated policy-as-code with Terraform, Ansible, and Puppet to satisfy global regulatory requirements without slowing developer velocity.

- Authored the CI/CD standards and golden paths that standardized deployment patterns for the broader engineering organization.

Migration to GitHub Enterprise Cloud

- Built the GitHub/Jira/ServiceNow orchestration behind PayPal's migration from GitHub Enterprise Server to GitHub Enterprise Cloud, cutting per-repo migration time from hours to minutes.
- Sustained throughput above 1,800 repos/day against a 30,000-repo backlog, completing the move and allowing PayPal to decommission self-hosted GitHub Enterprise Server entirely.
- Traced recurring CI/CD failures across multiple teams to an undetected single point of failure in GitHub's webhook path and implemented redundant architecture.
- Audited three months and 3,500+ requests against the AI support bot serving a CTO-tracked, company-wide migration program, isolating and fixing the ~15% of volume it was answering from contradictory documentation.

GitHub Apps and developer self-service

- Built and operate the catalog of custom GitHub Apps behind PayPal's developer self-service: repository access requests, branch-protection bypass exemptions, webhook creation, and GitHub App installation and approval.
- Instrumented pull-request traceability and code-quality reporting across the enterprise, covering branch-protection coverage, Jira references enforced in commit messages and PR titles, and Harness build and deploy quality signals surfaced back to owning teams.
- Automated repository migration through deployment-driven workflows, with the reporting used to track program progress.

Information Security Engineer · 2016 – 2020

Edge and API security

- Deployed custom Signal Sciences WAF containers managed with Terraform, covering 90%+ of enterprise ingress traffic.
- Scaled Traceable's API-security coverage to 200M+ daily calls within 72 hours, keeping real-time detection ahead of production traffic growth.

Fleet telemetry and vulnerability management

- Engineered osquery and Uptycs telemetry across 300k+ endpoints, 100k+ containers, and 1M+ images, with reporting pipelines built on Presto and SQL.
- Migrated the Aqua vulnerability-management platform from legacy VMs to GKE to SaaS, extending automated scanning visibility to 1M+ container images.

Secure infrastructure delivery

- Automated provisioning for the security platform fleet with Terraform, Ansible, and Puppet, applying security-by-design defaults across cloud and on-prem environments so controls shipped with the infrastructure instead of being retrofitted onto it.
- Automated JFrog Artifactory HA upgrades with Terraform and Helm, cutting a multi-sprint manual migration down to under four hours.
- Responded to platform security incidents including an insider-threat data-exfiltration case and critical secret-exposure remediations, coordinating directly with InfoSec and GitHub Support.

Earlier Roles

- **Expedia Group** · Senior Linux System Administrator · Scottsdale, AZ
- **Vonage Business** · Senior Systems Engineer · Scottsdale, AZ
- **OneNeck IT Solutions** · Unix Systems Administrator III · Scottsdale, AZ

Patents

- **U.S. Patent 11,818,219** (co-inventor): Session management and behavior analytics to prevent data exfiltration, implemented as a bastion gateway built on open-source tooling and running in PayPal's production security stack. Granted November 2023.

Certifications

- Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect
- CISSP & CCSP
- LPIC-1, LPIC-2, LPIC-3 (Linux Professional Institute)

Education

Associate of Applied Science, Linux Networking Administration Mesa Community College, AZ